HF-24 MARUT HAL's first indigenously developed fighter-bomber aircraft saw action in the 1971 Bangladesh war



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GETTY IMAGES



MAJESTIC CLASS Indian Air Force's HAL Tejas performs at the 2021 Dubai Airshow

noughties, the DRDO incorporated a systems engineering approach to develop complex missile systems such as Prithvi, Lakshya, the Ajeya tank, bridge layer tank, and the BLT-T72 or the mobile bridging system. The turn of the century saw the DRDO design and develop systems in nearly all areas of defence technology, be it aeronautics, armaments, electronics, land combat engineering, sensors, avionics, wireless and satellite communication systems, electronic warfare, materials, missiles and naval systems. A new joint venture was started for the Russia-developed supersonic cruise missile—BrahMos. Now, the DRDO is committed to the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat, to reduce the country's dependence on arms imports. ■

DRDO MILESTONES

1996
Combat Vehicles Research and Development Establishment develops **Arjun**, India's own main battle tank



2001
Tejas, India's own fighter jet, developed by the Aeronautical Development Agency, takes first flight





2009
Akash, the first surface-to-air missile designed and developed indigenously inducted into service. It has a range of 30 km



2002
Agni-1, capable of carrying a nuclear warhead missile, developed. Its range–700 km

2011
First flight of **NETRA**, the airborne early warning and control system



2017
ATAGS, an indigenous 155 mm x 52 calibre howitzer gun, the world's longest-range 155 mm gun, developed



2019
ASAT tested during Mission Shakti

